



Discussion Guide: Jim Wallis

Crossing the Color Line

Reflect

- Jim describes his “second conversion” as a time when he came to mature in his faith through a deeper understanding of what was happening in his community. Have you had a second conversion? If so, what did you come to understand or realize about yourself, God, or the world?
- What experiences have you had “crossing the color line”? Where and when did it happen? What questions or feelings did this experience bring to the surface?
- Jim’s talk brings together questions about both religion and politics. In your opinion, should religion and politics ever be mixed or should they be kept apart? What experiences, values, or beliefs inform your perspective?

Respond

- Jim contends that racism is not just personal, but structural. He then gives several examples of structural racism in the mid-20th century (FHA loans, GI Bill, gerrymandering). What are some concrete examples of structural racism today? How do they impact your community?
- Broadly defined, White Christian nationalism refers to the belief that the US is meant to be a Christian nation in which being white is normative. Jim refers to White Christian nationalism as a type of heresy. In your opinion, what are some aspects of Jesus’ life and teaching that defy and challenge the notion of White Christian nationalism?